STHIROS
Strategy. Risk. Cyber. AI.

Delivering $60M+ in benefits across a multi-year, multi-country BFSI transformation

A leading banking and financial services institution engaged Sthiros for a multi-year, multi-country operational transformation spanning retail banking, credit cards, and lending.



Client	Service	Sector	Geography
A Leading Banking & Financial Services Institution	**Enterprise-Wide Operational Excellence & Digital Transformation**	**Banking, Financial Services & Insurance**	**Global, Multi-Country**

The Challenge:

When idle cash and manual process cap what the bank can deploy

This institution needed comprehensive operational transformation to improve efficiency, reduce costs, enhance customer experience, and optimise capital deployment across retail banking, credit card, and lending operations, addressing cash optimisation, process digitisation, and turnaround time in one programme.

Suboptimal Cash Management

$35 million per day of idle cash sat locked in ATMs and Branches, unavailable for lending or investment.

Lengthy Credit-to-Cash Turnaround

Slow credit-to-cash cycle times were impacting customer experience and competitive position.

Manual, Paper-Based Processes

Limited straight-through-processing capability meant manual, paper-based work still drove most transaction volume.

Fragmented, Generalist Process Execution

Process execution was fragmented across channels and business units, with no hyper-specialisation or industrialisation in operations.

Outdated SOPs for Digital-First Operations

Standard Operating Procedures were built for a paper-first era and inadequate for digital-first banking.

Lack of Low-Cost Automation Pipeline

No structured pipeline existed to identify and capture low-cost automation opportunities across operations.

The Solution:

A multi-pillar transformation, from cash to capability

Sthiros ran a multi-pillar transformation combining cash optimisation, digitisation, process reengineering, and capability building, addressing the full operational stack rather than any single function in isolation.

300+ SOPs were rebuilt for digital-first operations, with governance, risk, and cybersecurity compliance embedded throughout.

The Methodology

1 Intelligent Cash Management & Optimisation

Predictive modelling for ATM and branch cash requirements, with dynamic deployment algorithms and real-time monitoring for proactive cash management.

2 Revenue Maximisation Initiatives

Fee optimisation analysis, pricing strategy refinement, and cross-sell enablement to systematically capture missed revenue opportunities.

3 Innovation & Digitisation Agenda

Straight-Through-Processing enabled through Capture at Source, migration to digital channels, and low-cost automation leveraging existing systems.

4 Hyper-Specialisation & Industrialisation

Centralised processing hubs with specialised teams by product and process, and a production-line approach to transaction processing.

5 Turnaround Time Reduction

Process bottlenecks eliminated through value stream mapping, with parallel processing replacing sequential workflows across credit cards and personal loans.

6 Process Standardisation

300+ Standard Operating Procedures revamped with digital-first design, role-based work instructions, and version-controlled governance.

What This Means

Idle cash is deployable capital.

Turnaround time is a sales pitch.

300 SOPs, one operating model.

Outcomes

$60M+

Total benefits delivered

Across cash optimisation, revenue maximisation, and turnaround time reduction.

30%

Idle cash balance reduced

Releasing $35M per day for productive deployment in lending and investment.

78%

Credit card TAT reduction

Faster credit-to-cash fulfilment improving customer satisfaction and competitive position.

62%

Personal loan TAT reduction

Faster processing enhancing customer experience and conversion.

Get in touch

Is your capital deployed, or just idle?

Speak to Sthiros about what an enterprise-wide operational transformation can unlock for your institution.

Connect with us:
sthiros.com

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